

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Atif Bhatti

Address: 20 Salisbury Avenue Cheam SM1 2DQ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to formally express my strong support for the proposed development to erect a new community structure intended to serve the youth, elderly, and wider local community. This initiative represents a meaningful and much-needed investment in local social infrastructure. A dedicated space for structured activities, educational programmes, social gatherings, and wellbeing initiatives will provide significant benefits across multiple age groups. For young people, such a facility offers a safe and constructive environment that encourages engagement, skill development, and positive social interaction. For elderly residents, it provides opportunities to reduce isolation, promote mental wellbeing, and maintain active participation within the community.

Importantly, the proposed development supports intergenerational interaction. Shared community spaces foster social cohesion, mutual understanding, and collective responsibility, strengthening the fabric of the neighbourhood as a whole. In an era where social fragmentation and loneliness are increasingly recognised challenges, accessible local facilities of this nature are not merely beneficial—they are essential.

From a broader perspective, developments that encourage organised activity and community engagement often contribute to reduced antisocial behaviour, improved wellbeing outcomes, and enhanced civic pride. The long-term social return on investment for such infrastructure is substantial.

I respectfully urge the Council to give favourable consideration to this application. The proposal aligns strongly with principles of community development, inclusivity, and preventative social support.